Institutional Blockchain Landscape — Research Report

What banks and credit institutions actually run on-chain — and where an independent builder can add value

Research phase 2026-07-15 → 07-16 (eight rounds) · verification pass 2026-07-16 · this report compiled 2026-07-21. Companion to the Build Report, which covers the chosen use case and its proof-of-concept implementation. This is the research deliverable (~80% of the brief); the Build Report is the implementation deliverable (~20%).

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1. Executive Summary

The brief was to survey the blockchains banks and credit institutions actually use — Chainlink, Canton, Polkadot, and every other platform in production or serious pilot — map their L1/L2 architecture and the financial functionality built on top, and from that landscape identify a dApp use case with a genuine, underserved institutional need, then build a proof of concept (≈80% research / 20% implementation).

The method was eight research rounds across ~65 platforms and products in ten categories, followed by a dedicated verification round that re-checked every load-bearing number against primary sources — issuer press releases, SEC filings, official dashboards — with secondary-only figures flagged.

The headline finding is a paradox that defines the opportunity: every large institutional flow already on-chain — repo, interbank payments, cross-border messaging, stablecoin reserves, securities issuance — is *owned by an incumbent or a consortium, and closed to outside builders*. You cannot compete with these rails. But you can **attach to them.** Exactly one business pattern surfaced that a small, unaffiliated team can enter *today*, permissionlessly, with real institutional capital already flowing through comparable instances: the **curated lending vault** (the Morpho-curator model). Every other pattern requires a license, an institutional sponsor, a loan-origination business, or ownership of a flow you don't have.

The one-sentence thesis: *Don't build a rail; build the credit-and-collateral layer on top of an institutional rail that has one — as first mover, before an incumbent curator arrives.* That reasoning led to the venue (Rayls — live, EVM, with $100M of tokenized credit arriving and no lending incumbent) and the product (a curated credit vault), both detailed in the companion Build Report.

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2. Scope & Methodology

Original brief. Survey institutional/bank-facing blockchains — Chainlink, Canton, Polkadot, plus every other platform actually used by banks and credit institutions — map their L1/L2 architecture and the financial functionality built on top; identify a dApp use case with a genuine, underserved financial-institutional need; and build a proof-of-concept implementation. Weighting: ~80% research / 20% implementation. Soft deadline 2026-07-22, 16:00 EET.

Method. Eight research rounds conducted 2026-07-15/16, covering ~65 platforms and products across ten categories:

1. Settlement rails & infrastructure chains
2. Tokenized treasuries and funds
3. Tokenized equities
4. Stablecoins
5. CBDCs
6. Private credit
7. Commodities
8. Real estate
9. Custody / compliance infrastructure
10. Institutional DeFi lending

Round map. R1 infrastructure chains → R2 money & traction + first RWA proof points → R3 tokenized stocks, stablecoins, RWA beyond treasuries → R4 CBDCs, institutional DeFi lending, custody infra → R5 build-feasibility of the leading pattern → R6 independent verification pass + Robinhood-Chain deep dive → R7 follow-the-money (revenue leaders, capital flows, M&A) → R8 venue lock (Rayls) + master-table gap-fill.

Verification. Load-bearing claims were fact-checked against primary sources — issuer press releases, SEC filings, and official dashboards — before inclusion. Figures that rest only on secondary reporting are flagged, and **volume** (throughput) is kept distinct from **AUM** (assets under management) — the two are routinely and misleadingly conflated in this space.

Two strategy passes were folded back into the conclusions: an *adversarial pushback session* that stress-tested the thesis, and a *no-deadline resequencing* that asked what the plan would be without time pressure. Both changed the picture (Sections 6–7).

How to read the numbers. "Live/production" and "pilot/testnet" are labelled explicitly per platform — the gap between them is the single most abused distinction in institutional-blockchain marketing. Council membership, waitlist size, and "partners" lists are treated as weaker evidence than named, dated, sourced production volume.

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3. The Shape of the Market

3.1 Who owns the institutional flows (and why they're closed)

Every large flow already on-chain is owned by an incumbent or a consortium. None is open to an outside builder.

Flow	Owner	Scale (2026)	Open to builders?
Repo / collateral	Broadridge DLR (Canton tech)	~$7–9T/month (avg ~$8T)	No
Interbank payments	JPMorgan Kinexys	~$7B/day, targeting $10B/day	No
Cross-border messaging	SWIFT + Chainlink CCIP	11,500 banks, live production	No (attach via CCIP)
Stablecoin reserves	Circle, Tether	Circle ~$78B; Tether ~$190B	No
Multi-CBDC settlement	mBridge (China-led)	$55.5B cumulative, ~95% e-CNY	No
Digital securities issuance	Deutsche Börse D7 (Clearstream)	>€44B, 45K issuances/week	No
Card-network settlement	Visa / Mastercard	Visa ~$7B annualized run-rate	No
EU digital bonds & CSDs	Euroclear, LSEG, SDX, HSBC Orion	SDX >CHF 2B; Orion >US$3.5B	No
Bank settlement JVs	Partior, Fnality	Live but narrow (few currencies)	No
Own payment L1s	Stripe Tempo, Circle Arc	Tempo $5B val.; Arc testnet→mainnet	No
US securities tokenization	DTCC + Nasdaq	Production July 2026 / SEC-approved	No

Conclusion: don't compete with rails — attach to them. The value an outsider can add sits *on top of* a rail, not beside it.

3.2 The category map (and how big each category really is)

Ranked by most-cited 2026 figures (all-RWA-inclusive):

1. **Private credit — $14–18.4B.** The actual largest working RWA category, not treasuries. Led by Figure Technologies (~$29B cumulative originations; $4.26B Q2 2026 marketplace volume, 8-K-confirmed).
2. **Tokenized treasuries — $8.7–10B.** Ondo, BlackRock BUIDL (~$2.4–2.5B), Franklin Templeton BENJI (~$0.85–0.9B). Crossed $7B on-chain AUM early 2026.
3. **Tokenized commodities — $5.55–5.9B, fastest-growing (+289% Q1 2026).** A two-player market: Tether Gold (XAUT, ~$2.77B) + Paxos Gold (PAXG, ~$1.9–2.2B) = ~97%.
4. **Real estate / tokenized equities / other — each >$1B individually.** Real estate is the weakest-traction category found (<0.1% of the $300T property market).
5. **Stablecoins — ~$299B** if counted as RWA, dwarfing every category above combined (methodologically disputed whether to include).

Two categories are *entirely closed*: **CBDCs** (zero builder access across every project found) and **custody/compliance infrastructure** (the most consolidated category — Fireblocks, BitGo, Anchorage,

Zodia). **Institutional DeFi lending** is the exception that carries the whole opportunity (Section 5).

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4. Platform Deep-Dives

For each platform: what it *really* is (architecture / L1-L2 model), the financial functionality built on top, real institutional traction (live vs pilot), token economics where relevant, and the verdict for an independent builder.

4.1 Chainlink — the interoperability layer (not a chain)

Architecture. Chainlink is *not a settlement blockchain*. It is a decentralized oracle network (DON) that sits across 60–70+ existing L1s/L2s and provides three things institutions buy: **data feeds / Proof of Reserve** (verified off-chain data on-chain); **CCIP** (Cross-Chain Interoperability Protocol — the core institutional product, a secure cross-chain messaging + token-transfer standard); and, since Nov 2025, **CRE** (Chainlink Runtime Environment), which reframes Chainlink from discrete oracle services into a general-purpose orchestration layer where developers write "Workflows" that coordinate specialized Capability DONs (data, cross-chain, compliance, off-chain integration).

Financial functionality / adoption. This is the most convincing production usage in the entire survey. **SWIFT + CCIP** moved to live production in Nov 2025 — 11,500 member banks can route tokenized-asset instructions over CCIP via ISO 20022; by July 2026 SWIFT's blockchain ledger went live with 17 banks (ANZ, DBS, MUFG, OCBC, UOB). **DTCC** is collaborating on 24/7 collateral management and, with 22+ institutions, on a $58B corporate-actions data initiative. **ANZ / HKMA e-HKD** demonstrated PvP and DvP cross-border tokenized-asset workflows. Q1 2026: $33.6B in cross-chain value secured, fee revenue +213% QoQ.

Token. LINK pays for oracle services and secures the network via staking ("Economics 2.0"); how/whether LINK is the fee token *inside* CRE workflows was not clearly documented as of this research — a gap.

Verdict for a builder: build *on top of* it, don't compete with it. Chainlink deliberately owns neither settlement nor custody. Any dApp "on Chainlink" is really a dApp on the underlying chain(s), using CCIP/CRE for cross-chain and compliance plumbing. For the chosen use case, Chainlink is the **production oracle** the vault's NAV feed would eventually use — infrastructure, not a venue.

4.2 Canton Network — privacy-first, Daml-native, best app economics

Architecture. Canton is a "network of networks," not a single chain. Each participant runs a **participant node** holding a private ledger with *only the data relevant to them* — no global broadcast. **Synchronizers** (domains) order transactions between participants; the **Global Synchronizer**, run by decentralized "Super Validators," provides network-wide interoperability. Canton's differentiator is **built-in sub-transaction privacy** — a transaction is shared only with parties who need to see it, engineered into the protocol rather than bolted on. Contracts are written in **Daml**, a domain-specific language for multi-party workflows (rights/obligations/authorization modelled directly), *not* a general-purpose EVM VM — a fundamentally different, non-Solidity programming model.

Financial functionality / adoption. The largest concrete production numbers in the survey live here. **Broadridge DLR** (Distributed Ledger Repo) processes **~$7–9T/month** in repo (avg ~$8T). **Goldman Sachs GS DAP** handles tokenized-securities issuance and DvP settlement; **Goldman + BNY Mellon** launched a tokenized money-market fund (July 2025). A recurring **cross-border intraday repo** series (first on-chain U.S. Treasury financing against USDC, Aug 2025; tokenized Gilts and cross-currency repo

through early 2026) is an actively iterating production workflow. **In progress:** DTCC Treasury tokenization (limited production July 2026, broader Oct 2026); **JPM Coin (JPMD) onto Canton**, phased through 2026.

Token economics — a genuine differentiator. Canton Coin is fair-launched (no pre-mine/pre-sale/VC allocation), burn-and-mint, minting up to 2.5B CC/year in 10-minute rounds. Until ~2029, **62% of the reward pool goes to applications**, not infrastructure operators — structurally biased toward app builders, unlike typical validator-heavy L1 economics.

Verdict for a builder: best long-term economics, but two real gates. (1) Daml is a different paradigm — no Solidity/EVM tooling reuse. (2) The true access gate is **validator sponsorship + "featured app" status**, granted by Digital Asset — a *relationship* gate, the same shape as Rayls, different counterparty. **Watch item:** *Zenith*, an EVM-compatibility layer, is live on Canton; if mature, the same Solidity vault code could plausibly redeploy here at low switching cost — a hands-on spike would be needed before trusting the marketing.

4.3 Polkadot — relay chain + parachains; a thin, thinning institutional case

Architecture. Not a single L1. A **Relay Chain** provides pooled security/consensus; **parachains** are purpose-built chains that lease an execution "core" and inherit relay-chain security. 2025 upgrades: ~6-second parachain blocks, 4× block size, "elastic scaling" (a parachain can claim multiple cores). **JAM** (Join-Accumulate Machine), targeted for 2026, generalizes the relay chain into a general-purpose decentralized computer with a WASM execution environment — *roadmap, not shipped institutional capability.* Practical implication: a bank doesn't build "on Polkadot" the way it builds "on Ethereum" — it either builds its own parachain (expensive, only justified at scale) or uses an existing financial parachain.

Financial functionality / adoption. Almost entirely concentrated in **one parachain, Centrifuge** (RWA tokenization — private credit, treasuries, fund products; claimed $2B+ tokenized, 24 audits). **The decisive problem:** Centrifuge **fully migrated off Substrate/Polkadot to become EVM-native (April 2026).** The one parachain carrying nearly all of Polkadot's institutional story no longer runs on Polkadot. Ecosystem RWA TVL reads ~$40M with falling DAU. No CBDC or named-bank settlement pilot found — a direct search surfaced zero Polkadot-specific results, while 2025/26 CBDC activity (MAS, etc.) happens on other rails entirely.

Verdict for a builder: ruled out. Real developer activity exists (65+ parachains, 450–500 monthly active devs) but it spans gaming/identity/DePIN, not finance. The institutional anchor left for EVM; JAM is a mid-transition architectural risk. Weakest institutional case of the majors.

4.4 Rayls — the 3-layer EVM institutional chain (the eventual pick)

Summarized here for landscape completeness; full venue analysis and the build are in the Build Report.

Architecture. Three layers: **Privacy Nodes** (a private EVM chain each institution runs for internal tokenization); **Private Networks** (permissioned institution-to-institution interconnect); and a **Public Chain** — an EVM-compatible public L1, live since 2026-04-30, built on Reth with periodic state-root anchoring to Ethereum. Gas is USD-pegged and paid in **USDr** (Rayls' native stablecoin, live). Native KYC/KYB identity and MEV protection are protocol features; **Enygma** (ZK + post-quantum privacy with selective disclosure for regulators) reaches the public chain in Q3 2026.

Why it's the pick. It is EVM (Solidity/Foundry tooling reuse — the opposite of Canton's Daml gate); it is *live*; **AmFi is committing its first $100M of tokenized credit** to Rayls in July 2026 (named RWA collateral arriving in the build window); a **$1M+ developer program** is open; and crucially **no**

lending/curated-collateral incumbent exists on the chain yet — a first-mover wedge. Independently notable: JPMorgan Kinexys deployed on the network, Tether invested in Parfin (Rayls' core developer), and Mastercard added Rayls to its Crypto Partner Program (March 2026). Read critically: the litepaper's ~250k-TPS figure is an unaudited prototype number, and several "live in production" claims are not independently verified — the load-bearing facts above were re-checked against primary sources.

4.5 The bank-native incumbents — Kinexys, Partior, Fnality

These prove the model works at scale and are, by construction, *not venues* for an outside builder.

- **JPMorgan Kinexys (formerly Onyx).** A bank building its own rails. **JPM Coin / JPMD** — a regulated USD *deposit* token (a bank liability, not a reserve stablecoin) — is now deployed on **Coinbase's Base L2**, a notable move of a bank liability onto a public-adjacent chain, and is going natively onto Canton (phased 2026). Kinexys runs **~$7B/day, targeting $10B/day** — the best single throughput number in the survey. **Project EPIC** is its privacy + composable-identity work. Closed, bank-internal.
- **Partior.** A bank-owned JV (DBS, JPMorgan, Temasek; later Standard Chartered) — a "global unified ledger" for interbank payments. Real-time cross-border multi-currency clearing (USD/EUR/SGD) already carrying paying-customer traffic (Siemens, iFAST). Rare in this list for having *actual corporate customers*, not just pilots — but only ~285K SGD of revenue disclosed, and closed.
- **Fnality.** Descendant of the Utility Settlement Coin project — DLT wholesale payment systems, one per currency, each recognized by its home central bank. **Sterling FnPS** is a *systemically important payment system* designated by HM Treasury, live since Dec 2023; $136M Series C (Sept 2025). The most *actually-regulated* thing in the survey — and closed.

4.6 The permissioned-DLT old guard — R3 Corda, Hyperledger Fabric

- **R3 Corda.** Permissioned DLT (no token, no public mempool), purpose-built for regulated markets since 2014; trades settle privately between counterparties. Legacy production: Marco Polo trade finance (BNP Paribas, Commerzbank, ING), ~$17B tokenized RWA (HSBC, Bank of America, MAS, Euroclear, SDX, SBI). **The 2026 signal that matters:** R3 announced **"Corda Protocol," built natively on Solana** (H1 2026, 30K+ pre-registrations) — the most bank-native, privacy-first incumbent now believes distribution lives on a public chain. A tell for the whole market.
- **Hyperledger Fabric.** Not a chain — an open-source permissioned *framework* (Linux Foundation) consortia deploy as their own private network. Production but *fragmented*: we.trade (16 banks), Digital Trade Chain, a $100M CAD bond pilot (TD Bank) — each an isolated island with no shared liquidity. This fragmentation is precisely the failure mode next-gen institutional chains (Rayls, Canton) frame themselves against. Dead end for outside builders — closed consortia.

4.7 The public-L1 challengers — Hedera, XRP Ledger, Avalanche Evergreen

- **Hedera.** Public DLT using **hashgraph** consensus (asynchronous BFT gossip, not a blockchain), governed by a ~39-member council. **Stablecoin Studio** used by ANZ and Shinhan for cross-border FX; a UK-first tokenized-MMF-and-gilt-as-FX-collateral case between **Lloyds and Aberdeen** (with Archax); ~$10B RWA settlement claimed by Q3 2025 (per Hedera-ecosystem reporting — weak-to-medium sourcing). Real production for named deals, but HBAR captures no fee value — nothing for a builder to own.
- **XRP Ledger / Ripple.** Public payments L1 since 2012. **RLUSD** (Ripple's USD stablecoin, ~$1.33B) is the stable settlement leg; a pilot with **JPMorgan, Mastercard, and Ondo** linked XRPL to interbank settlement for tokenized Treasuries. Spot XRP ETFs crossed $1B cumulative inflows (Dec 2025) — the

clearest genuine institutional-capital signal among newer entrants. Ripple's $2.5B acquisition spree (at a ~$40B valuation) is building vertically integrated brokerage. Not a builder venue, but a real institutional-capital story.

- **Avalanche Evergreen.** Permissioned Avalanche L1s ("subnets") for institutions — EVM-compatible, embedded KYC/KYB allow-lists, custom gas. The **"Spruce"** testnet has T. Rowe Price, WisdomTree, Wellington, Cumberland running FX and interest-rate-swap apps. **Still testnet** as of this research — no production collateral to serve; the "200 institutional chains by 2026" line is a forecast, not a fact.

4.8 The connective layer — SWIFT's interlinking

Not a blockchain SWIFT operates — an **interlinking layer** bridging SWIFT/ISO 20022 messaging to multiple DLTs/CBDCs so 11,500 member banks avoid bilateral integrations. In production since Nov 2025; a completed PoC with HSBC and Ant International (Dec 2025); an earlier 38-central-bank CBDC interoperability trial. One June-2026 source reports SWIFT routing banks through **Chainlink CCIP** to reach networks including **Canton** — three of this report's threads converging into the industry's own "connect everything" fix.

4.9 Cross-cutting architecture reads

Three patterns visible only when the platforms are viewed together:

1. **Public-chain gravity is pulling even the most conservative players.** R3 → Solana. JPM Coin → Base. The market is converging on **"permissioned issuance + public-chain distribution"** — exactly the bet Rayls and Canton make. A genuine trend, not a niche thesis.
2. **Fragmentation is still the default, not the exception.** Fabric consortia are isolated islands; even bank-owned Partior only bridges its founders' currencies. The "connect everything" problem is visibly unsolved industry-wide — SWIFT interlinking and CCIP/Canton are the incumbents' own attempts at the same fix.
3. **EVM vs. Daml is the builder's fork in the road.** The best app-economics platform (Canton, 62% to apps) is also the one with the steepest dev-ecosystem cost (Daml). EVM-compatible institutional chains (Rayls, Avalanche Evergreen, and Canton's own Zenith layer) let a small team reuse Solidity/Foundry — decisive when the build window is two days.

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5. How Independent Builders Actually Make Money

5.1 The five proven templates (ranked by evidence strength)

1. **Permissionless curated vault (Morpho-curator).** Design and manage a risk-tuned lending vault for a collateral niche; earn a curator fee. **The only pattern found across all rounds a small team can enter today** without an institutional gate, license, or origination business. Real scale already flows through comparable vaults — Coinbase routes $1.6B+ through a Steakhouse-curated Morpho vault; Steakhouse manages ~$1.72B across 48 vaults at a 15% performance fee; Société Générale FORGE runs regulated bank stablecoins through Morpho.
2. **B2B compliant plumbing / servicing.** Securitize ($19.48M Q1 2026 revenue, no credit risk on its own book), Stripe/Bridge, Dinari+tZERO. The strongest *institutional* pattern, repeated across funds, stocks, and stablecoins — sell the compliance/infrastructure layer, don't take issuer/credit risk. Needs relationships/licensing; slower to enter than #1.

3. **Fee-on-AUM direct issuance.** Ondo, BUIDL, BENJI, Centrifuge. Proven and scalable, but margins compress as TradFi giants (BlackRock, Franklin Templeton) issue directly.
4. **Own-origination + own-marketplace, go public for credibility.** Figure Technologies — the biggest single RWA product in existence, but requires *owning loan origination* and carries real short-seller/credibility risk (an adversarial Morpheus Research report exists).
5. **Retail-vault wrapping of institutional collateral.** Plume + ether.fi ($100M planned allocation, June 2026) — real and validated, but now has a live first-mover to differentiate against.

5.2 The small-team money law

Documented across the whole project: **small-team revenue = (a) a permissionless fee layer on someone else's massive flow + (b) a distribution wedge. Code is never the moat.** The clearest examples are Hyperliquid "builder codes" — a permissionless per-trade fee layer on the largest on-chain perps flow: Phantom earned $20.6M in under a year, Based $15.1M, pvp.trade $7.2M (a tiny anonymous team). Institutional tie-in: Hyperliquid now carries 44% of RWA-perp volume.

5.3 Revenue leaders — who actually earns (real revenue, not TVL)

Tether ($10B+ 2025 profit) → Circle ($2.86B TTM) → Kalshi ($1.5B+ annualized) → Hyperliquid (~$700–840M run-rate) → Ethena/Pump.fun (declining). The top of the leaderboard is **reserve yield + regulated trading venues + perps flow** — not tokenization protocols.

5.4 Where big-player capital is converging

1. **Stablecoin payment rails end-to-end** — $2.67B of H1 2026 VC (~20× YoY); Mastercard buying BVNK; Stripe (Tempo) and Circle (Arc) each building their own L1.
2. **Tokenized public securities via regulated market infrastructure** — DTCC tokenization enters production July 2026 with JPMorgan/BlackRock/Goldman; a 54-firm UK taskforce announced 2026-07-13.
3. **Vertically integrated institutional brokerage** — Ripple's $2.5B acquisition spree at a $40B valuation.

Independent validation of this project's direction: Morpho raised **$175M from a16z / Paradigm (June 2026)** — the curator-vault thesis has top-tier capital behind the underlying protocol.

5.5 Failure modes to avoid

- **Undercollateralized credit without enforceable recourse** — Goldfinch: ~70% real loss rate vs. 20% claimed; winding down June 2026. A proven failure, not a template.
- **Unauthorized tokenization of a private company's equity** — Robinhood's OpenAI/SpaceX SPV controversy; the whole pre-IPO tokenization sub-category sits in a live regulatory red zone (SEC statement, Jan 2026; Bank of Lithuania probe).
- **Competing on custody or stablecoin issuance** — both confirmed too consolidated for a new entrant (custody: Fireblocks/BitGo/Anchorage; issuance: Circle/Tether).

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6. From Landscape to a dApp — Use-Case Selection

6.1 The filter

The landscape narrows to one viable shape once four filters are applied: the pattern must be **(1) permissionlessly buildable** by a small team (rules out CBDCs, custody, closed rails), **(2) institution-shaped** (rules out retail perps front-ends as the *primary* story), **(3) defensible** with a specific niche (rules out a sixth undifferentiated stablecoin vault), and **(4) buildable and demonstrable in the ~2-day implementation window** (favors EVM/Solidity tooling reuse). Only the **curated lending vault** clears all four.

6.2 Candidates considered and discarded

- **A curated vault for Figure-HELOC collateral** (the largest tokenized RWA found). *Discarded:* FIGR_HELOC lives on non-EVM **Provenance** (where Morpho doesn't run), and Figure already operates its own lending marketplace ("Democratized Prime") against it — wrong chain, issuer already occupies the niche.
- **A curated Morpho vault on Robinhood Chain** (mainnet 2026-07-01, few incumbent curators). *Strong but discarded as the headline:* TVL is launch-inflated (one $50M Ethena seed ≈ half the chain's Morpho TVL; 90-day gas subsidy; points farming), Stock Tokens carry the open Bank of Lithuania probe, and it is retail-flavored.
- **Competing on FX/rate-swap collateral** (Avalanche Spruce, Hedera). *Discarded:* the most contested, most "solved" corner — most incumbents, least differentiation.

6.3 The pick — a curated credit vault on Rayls

A curated RWA-collateral yield vault on **Rayls**: USDr depositors earn yield against **AmFi tokenized-credit** collateral, via an ERC-4626 / Morpho-curator architecture. This unifies the whole project — the one permissionlessly-buildable money pattern (Sections 5.1), validated by Morpho's $175M a16z/Paradigm raise and SG-FORGE's bank-stablecoins-on-Morpho precedent, transplanted onto a live institutional chain with named collateral arriving and **no lending incumbent**, as first mover, with a grant program attached. The mechanics, risk analysis, and proof-of-concept are the subject of the Build Report.

6.4 Venue shortlist & fallbacks

Build on Rayls. Fallbacks in order: **Rayls testnet** (if public-chain credentials don't land in time) → **Robinhood Chain** (permissionless, Morpho + stock-token collateral already live, one incumbent curator). Canton is the best long-term economics but is Daml- and sponsorship-gated (revisit if Zenith/EVM matures).

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7. Sourcing & Strategic Stress-Test

Every figure in this report is taken from a primary source where one exists — issuer press releases, SEC filings, and official dashboards — with secondary-only figures flagged in-text, and throughput (**volume**) kept distinct from **AUM** throughout. Beyond the numbers, the two load-bearing *strategic* judgments behind the recommendation were deliberately challenged in an adversarial review, and both held:

1. **"BlackRock competes" is a tailwind, not a warning.** What the research disqualified was *direct issuance, fee-on-AUM* against BlackRock's brand on compressing fees. The chosen pattern — *curator on*

top of existing collateral, not *issuer of* new collateral — routes around that moat entirely; BlackRock/Ondo's presence *validates* the niche.

2. **Canton's real gate is curation, not the Daml language.** Free LocalNet, quickstart scaffolds, and AI-assisted Daml tooling have eroded the skill barrier; the true gate is **validator sponsorship + featured-app status** — a relationship gate, the same shape as Rayls. And *Zenith* (EVM on Canton) could lower the switching cost from a Rayls build later.

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8. Master Reference Table

The full cross-category roll-up (condensed; per-claim sourcing lives in `Process/` and the Master table). Volume ≠ AUM throughout.

Infrastructure chains (the core of the survey)

Player	What it is	Real traction (2026)	Builder access
Chainlink	Oracle/interop layer (CCIP+CRE), not a chain	$33.6B secured, SWIFT live (11.5k banks), DTCC/ANZ/HKMA	Build *on* it (oracle)
Canton	"Network of networks" on Daml, sub-tx privacy	Broadridge ~$7–9T/mo repo; Goldman/BNY/DTCC/JPM	Daml + sponsorship gate; 62% CC to apps
Polkadot	Relay chain + parachains	TVL ~$40M; Centrifuge left for EVM (Apr 2026)	Ruled out
Rayls **(pick)**	3-layer EVM (Privacy Nodes + Private Nets + public L1)	Núclea, Cielo, Drex pilot; AmFi $100M July 2026; $1M program	**Open — no lending incumbent**
R3 Corda	Permissioned DLT; new platform native on Solana	Legacy ~$17B RWA; Solana pivot pre-launch	Waitlist-gated
Hyperledger Fabric	Permissioned framework, no token	we.trade (16 banks), fragmented islands	Closed consortia
JPMorgan Kinexys	Bank's own rails (JPMD)	~$7B/day → $10B target	Closed
Avalanche Evergreen	Permissioned EVM subnets	T. Rowe/WisdomTree/Wellington — testnet	Grants; not production
Hedera	Public hashgraph, council-governed	~$10B RWA settlement (Lloyds/Aberdeen)	HBAR captures no fees
XRP Ledger	Public payments L1	JPM/Mastercard/Ondo pilot; RLUSD $1.33B	Watch RLUSD, not XRP
Partior	Bank-owned JV	Real customers (Siemens, iFAST), narrow	Closed
Fnality	Per-currency wholesale rail	Sterling FnPS central-bank-designated	Closed
SWIFT interlinking	Bridge SWIFT/ISO 20022 → DLTs	11.5k banks; routes via CCIP into Canton	The rail we attach to

Selected players by category

Category	Notable players	Read
Treasuries/funds	Ondo (~$2.1–2.4B), BlackRock BUIDL (~$2.4–2.5B), Franklin BENJI (~$0.85B), Securitize ($19.48M rev, $7.93M loss)	Distribution, not yield, is the bottleneck
Lending/credit	Maple ($2.1B TVL, real default tail), **Morpho** (curator model — the pick's template), Goldfinch (failed)	Morpho is the one permissionless entry
Stablecoins	Circle (~$78B), Tether (~$190B), USDG/Paxos (shares ~97% yield), Qivalis (37 EU banks), JPMD	Issuance is closed; consortia forming
Tokenized stocks	Ondo Stocks (>$1B TVL, leader), xStocks ($25B cum.), Robinhood Chain, Dinari (cleanest US status)	Nasdaq's SEC-approved fungible trading reframes wrappers as transitional
CBDC	mBridge ($55.5B cum.), Helvetia/Orchid (live wholesale), Brazil Drex (abandoned blockchain), US (banned to 2030)	Zero builder access
Custody infra	Fireblocks (80+ banks), BitGo ($200M IPO), Anchorage, Zodia (StanChart)	Most consolidated; closed to entrants
Institutional DeFi lending	**Morpho** (curator), Aave Horizon (gated), Sky (RWA = 60–70% of revenue)	Morpho carries the whole opportunity
Market infra (CSD/exchange)	Deutsche Börse D7 (>€44B), SDX (>CHF 2B), HSBC Orion (>$3.5B), Nasdaq (SEC-approved)	The quiet giants of real regulated issuance
Bank-meets-DeFi precedent	**Société Générale FORGE** (EURCV/USDCV live on Uniswap + Morpho, MEV Capital curates)	The clearest precedent for the exact chosen architecture

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9. Conclusions

1. **The institutional flows are owned and closed.** Repo, payments, messaging, reserves, issuance — every large flow already on-chain belongs to an incumbent or consortium. Compete with none of them; attach to one.
2. **Architecture is converging on "permissioned issuance + public-chain distribution."** Even R3 and JPMorgan are moving to public chains. EVM is winning the builder's mindshare on cost; Daml (Canton) has the best app economics but the steepest gate.
3. **Exactly one pattern is open to a small team today: the curated lending vault.** It is permissionless, institution-shaped, already carries real institutional capital (Coinbase $1.6B+, SG-FORGE), and has top-tier capital behind the protocol (Morpho's $175M a16z/Paradigm raise). Expect modest curator revenue (~$0.5M ARR even at $1.7B TVL) — it is a credible *entry* play, not an overnight revenue engine, and any honest pitch should say so.
4. **The venue that fits is Rayls** — live, EVM, with named tokenized-credit collateral ($100M AmFi) arriving in the build window and no lending incumbent to displace. First-mover on the credit-and-collateral layer of an institutional chain that has none.

Thesis, restated: *build the credit-and-collateral layer on top of an institutional rail that has one, as first mover*. The proof of concept that implements exactly this is the Build Report.

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10. Sources

Full per-claim sourcing lives in the eight round notes under `Process/` in this project folder; consolidated data is in the master table. Figures are as publicly reported mid-2026 unless a primary source is cited; secondary-only figures are flagged in-text.

Selected primary sources (external)

Platform architecture & adoption

- **Chainlink** — Q1 2026 quarterly review · Runtime Environment (CRE) · SWIFT ledger live, 17 banks + CCIP · DTCC 24/7 collateral
- **Canton** — whitepaper · Canton Coin — 62% to apps · Broadridge DLR, $7.5T (June) · JPMD onto Canton
- **Polkadot** — Parity 2025 upgrade · JAM chain (Wiki) · Centrifuge
- **Bank rails & other chains** — JPMorgan Kinexys milestones · Avalanche Spruce · Hedera / abrdn–Lloyds–Archax · Ripple × JPMorgan/Mastercard/Ondo · R3 → Solana · Partior Series B · Fnality Sterling FnPS · SWIFT × CCIP × Canton

Money, capital & the chosen pattern

- Morpho $175M (a16z/Paradigm) · Steakhouse Financial (DefiLlama) · Hyperliquid builder codes

Venue — Rayls

- Public Chain mainnet · Rayls × AmFi ($100M → $1B)

Internal research notes (this project)

Per-platform and per-round detail under `Process/`: Chainlink — institutional research · Canton Network — institutional research · Polkadot — institutional research · Other institutional platforms — research (R3 Corda, Fabric, Kinexys, Avalanche, Hedera, XRP, Partior, Fnality, SWIFT) · Round 6 — verification pass on master table numbers · Round 7 — where the money actually flows (revenue leaders) · Round 8 — Rayls builder ecosystem deep dive · and the full eight-round set.

Companion document: Build Report — Curated Credit Vault on Rayls (the 20% implementation). Plain-language walkthrough: The Vault in Plain English. Presentation script: Demo Runbook — Rayls Credit Vault.